

and couldn't imagine stopping. By the time she was twenty-seven years old, she had received both her master's and doctorate degree in philosophy.

Having attained the highest education level possible, she had exhausted her days as a student and now had to make the transition to an employee. This turned out to be difficult. Beatrice searched for six months without any success finding employment in her chosen field. Any time she looked in the job classified section for a category called "philosophy" or typed in that word for a computer search of jobs, she came up with no matches.

Beatrice was getting nervous about her job prospects, especially since her student loan repayment had reached the end of its six-month grace period. Not knowing what to do, Beatrice scheduled an appointment with her former academic advisor in the philosophy department. This meeting provided her with more than just advice. She found out about the scheduled retirement of one of the members of the faculty. Beatrice applied for the vacancy and got the job.

Even though the starting pay was relatively low, what really made Beatrice feel trapped was the lack of other alternatives. She was able to afford her student loan payments only by living an extremely frugal lifestyle. She took her bicycle to class, even in the snow, and lived a lifestyle not unlike that of the "starving student."

Beatrice had failed to consider the question "How much in demand is a degree in philosophy?" If she had done some research, she would have probably discovered that this degree, like similar degrees in ancient history, Latin studies, or Shakespeare, had a limited demand. While these are all important and respectable areas of study, if obtaining a high salary is important to you, you will need to become trained in a more sought-after field.

